enough to get along.

I asked him to send me a letter formally offering me the position and then I went home wondering if I ought to accept it.

8

Back in New York, everyone at Columbia told me to jump at the offer, and if the school had been located in New York I would have.

I love New York. I had never felt at home in Philadelphia and I don't know that I would ever feel at home in Boston. And yet I didn't love New York to the point of wanting to starve in it.

I attended to my other affairs while trying to come to a decision. For instance, I had to get the manuscript of "Grow Old with Me" over to Fred Pohl.

I walked over to his apartment on March n and found he wasn't in. (After a lifetime without a phone, I couldn't seem to get the hang of the notion that one calls a person first, to see if he's in and willing to receive, before one walks over.)

What I did next is hard for me to believe, even though my diary says I did it, and I remember I did it These days, when I deliver a manuscript, I take it to the editor personally, and don't let go of it till I

see that the editor has a good grip on it. Furthermore, I make him or her swear on the River Styx that he or she won't lose it. If the editor were too far for a personal trip, I would send the manuscript by registered mail, return receipt requested, and threaten the entire post office with instant thermonuclear annihilation if anything went wrong.

In this case, though, on March 11, 1949, I was so utterly uninterested in "Grow Old with Me" that when Judy Merril's eight-year-old daughter, Merril, answered the door and said, in her childish treble, that neither her stepfather nor her mother was home, I thrust my manuscript at the eight-year-old infant, said, "Here—give this to your old man when you see him/' and marched off.

9

I finally got my own citizenship papers. That didn't make me any more a citizen or any less a citizen than before. I had been a citizen ever since 1928. With my own papers, however, I didn't have to get my father's every time I